SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

25 July 2022 · Shift 2

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Kill two birds with one stone

(A) Make peace after an argument
(B) Face several problems at a time
(C) Act cordially despite conflict
(D) To achieve two things by doing a single action

Q.2

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. When I reached there she have already started eating.

(A) No error
(B) When I reached
(C) there she have
(D) already started eating

Q.3

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Not everything "that happen in natures" is due to global warming alone.

(A) that happening on nature
(B) which happens in natures
(C) No improvement required
(D) that happens in nature

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bite someone's head off

(A) Respond to someone with anger that is often sudden or unprovoked
(B) Ignoring something that is evidently wrong or unavoidable
(C) Cause something to be done in a new way
(D) Guessing or estimating without full information

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The park is a/an _____ place to stroll and exercise.

(A) unopen
(B) doubtful
(C) ideal
(D) fussy

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Instead of unambiguous statements, the Union contents itself with "simple" analyses.

(A) Complex
(B) clear
(C) Auspicious
(D) Antiquated

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Students of St. Xavier's _____ away all the prizes.

(A) bearing
(B) bore
(C) borne
(D) bears

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The truck picked up "more then" the usual amount of garbage from our neighbourhood.

(A) greater then
(B) more than
(C) much than
(D) No improvement required

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An abbreviation formed from the initial letters of other words and pronounced as a word

(A) Caption
(B) Slogan
(C) Flotilla
(D) Acronym

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My mother _____ the maid for her hard work.

(A) priced
(B) prized
(C) praised
(D) prayed

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Bustle

(A) Rush
(B) Praise
(C) Force
(D) Block

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Contencious
(B) Prevaricate
(C) Refute
(D) Revere

Q.13

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Surgical strike is not the only solution to this problem standing at front of us.

(A) No error
(B) Surgical strike is not the
(C) only solution to this problem
(D) standing at front of us

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Reliable

(A) Doubtful
(B) Dependable
(C) Dubious
(D) Dodgy

Q.15

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. In the nineteenth century, many new ideas about education and learning "were being emerged."

(A) was emerging
(B) have emerging
(C) No improvement required
(D) emerged

Q.16

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Lucy was annoyed to discover / that her husband / had taking her car keys.

(A) No error
(B) that her husband
(C) Lucy was annoyed to discover
(D) had taking her car keys

Q.17

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. I "gives him some" orange juice from the refrigerator.

(A) gave him some
(B) gives him any
(C) given him some
(D) No improvement required

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Pragmatic

(A) Prudent
(B) Aesthetic
(C) Impractical
(D) Dull

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The main street, which is neither broad nor _____, runs past this square on its way to the railway-station.

(A) shallow
(B) wide
(C) high
(D) narrow

Q.20

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. I should seccure some company for my lonelly hours.

(A) I should sicure some company for my lonelie hours.
(B) I should secur some company for my loneley hours.
(C) I should secoure some company for my lonely hours.
(D) I should secure some company for my lonely hours.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tragedy has once again struck the Valachukettil family of Sooppikkada village in Kerala's Kozhikode district as one more member (1) _____ to the Nipah virus infection on Thursday. District Medical Officer V Jayashree told that V Moosa, 60, who had been (2) _____ treatment at Baby Memorial Hospital in the city, died on May 24 morning. This is the fourth death in the family as Moosa's sons Mohammed Sabith and Mohammed Salih, and sister-in-law Mariyam too had died of the infection (3) _____ May. With this, the death (4) _____ due to the virus infection has gone up to 12. Two persons, whose blood and body fluid samples were (5) _____ positive for the infection, are undergoing treatment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) died
(B) succumbed
(C) pioneered
(D) embezzled

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tragedy has once again struck the Valachukettil family of Sooppikkada village in Kerala's Kozhikode district as one more member (1) _____ to the Nipah virus infection on Thursday. District Medical Officer V Jayashree told that V Moosa, 60, who had been (2) _____ treatment at Baby Memorial Hospital in the city, died on May 24 morning. This is the fourth death in the family as Moosa's sons Mohammed Sabith and Mohammed Salih, and sister-in-law Mariyam too had died of the infection (3) _____ May. With this, the death (4) _____ due to the virus infection has gone up to 12. Two persons, whose blood and body fluid samples were (5) _____ positive for the infection, are undergoing treatment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) working
(B) managing
(C) devising
(D) undergoing

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tragedy has once again struck the Valachukettil family of Sooppikkada village in Kerala's Kozhikode district as one more member (1) _____ to the Nipah virus infection on Thursday. District Medical Officer V Jayashree told that V Moosa, 60, who had been (2) _____ treatment at Baby Memorial Hospital in the city, died on May 24 morning. This is the fourth death in the family as Moosa's sons Mohammed Sabith and Mohammed Salih, and sister-in-law Mariyam too had died of the infection (3) _____ May. With this, the death (4) _____ due to the virus infection has gone up to 12. Two persons, whose blood and body fluid samples were (5) _____ positive for the infection, are undergoing treatment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) through
(B) on
(C) in
(D) for

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tragedy has once again struck the Valachukettil family of Sooppikkada village in Kerala's Kozhikode district as one more member (1) _____ to the Nipah virus infection on Thursday. District Medical Officer V Jayashree told that V Moosa, 60, who had been (2) _____ treatment at Baby Memorial Hospital in the city, died on May 24 morning. This is the fourth death in the family as Moosa's sons Mohammed Sabith and Mohammed Salih, and sister-in-law Mariyam too had died of the infection (3) _____ May. With this, the death (4) _____ due to the virus infection has gone up to 12. Two persons, whose blood and body fluid samples were (5) _____ positive for the infection, are undergoing treatment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) tole
(B) toll
(C) scroll
(D) roll

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tragedy has once again struck the Valachukettil family of Sooppikkada village in Kerala's Kozhikode district as one more member (1) _____ to the Nipah virus infection on Thursday. District Medical Officer V Jayashree told that V Moosa, 60, who had been (2) _____ treatment at Baby Memorial Hospital in the city, died on May 24 morning. This is the fourth death in the family as Moosa's sons Mohammed Sabith and Mohammed Salih, and sister-in-law Mariyam too had died of the infection (3) _____ May. With this, the death (4) _____ due to the virus infection has gone up to 12. Two persons, whose blood and body fluid samples were (5) _____ positive for the infection, are undergoing treatment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) implemented
(B) supported
(C) tested
(D) rested

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'life and love' is written as 'ri ti gi', 'life is tangible' is written as 'mi pi ri', and 'love is pure' is written as 'mi gi oi'. How will 'love' be written in that language?

(A) gi
(B) mi
(C) ti
(D) oi

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. SUT5 : PRQ11 :: DFE8 : ACB14 :: LNM12 : ?

(A) IKJ18
(B) UWV14
(C) STU16
(D) UVW18

Q.4

In a company, seven employees A, B, C, M, K, L and O work on 7 different levels (1 being the highest and 7 being the lowest level). B is above C and C is above just two employees. There are more than four employees above M. B is one level above A and one level below K. L is at level 7. K is below O. How many employees are above A?

(A) Four
(B) Two
(C) Three
(D) Five

Q.5

What will be the value of the given expression if ‘A’ means ‘+’, ‘B’ means ‘–’, ‘C’ means ‘×’, and ‘D’ means ‘÷’?
25 B 35 A 12 C 25 D 5 = ?

(A) 45
(B) 50
(C) 55
(D) 40

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PIN : VAX :: RBX : ?

(A) YUH
(B) XUH
(C) XVH
(D) XTH

Q.8

In a certain code language, ‘Tings are black red’ is coded as ‘pr 6 @ rm’, ‘Black yellow creatures’ is coded as ‘fg rm 9’, and ‘Hinge are creatures’ is coded as ‘@ lp fg’. What is the code for ‘creatures are’ in that language?

(A) fg pr
(B) fg rm
(C) fg @
(D) lp 9

Q.9

In a certain code language, ‘Phones are burning’ is coded as ‘7 8 3’, and ‘That coach was burning’ is coded as ‘6 3 2 4’. What can be the code for ‘are’ in that language?

(A) 3
(B) 2
(C) 8
(D) 6

Q.10

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some X are M. II. Some D are M. Conclusions: I. All X are D. II. No M is D. III. Some X are not D.

(A) Only conclusions II and III follow
(B) Only conclusion III follows
(C) All the conclusions follow
(D) None of the conclusions follow

Q.11

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number-pair. 19 : 57 :: ?

(A) 23 : 47
(B) 31 : 91
(C) 29 : 87
(D) 17 : 47

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g.13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 12 : 8 :: 28 : 16 :: 6 : ?

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 6

Q.14

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some tyres are bats. II. All tyres are laws. Conclusions: I. All laws are bats. II. All bats are tyres.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'WORK' is coded as '67', and 'CUP' is coded as '40'. How will 'KITE' be coded in that code language?

(A) 36
(B) 45
(C) 38
(D) 42

Q.17

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 16 : 45 :: 36 : 105 :: 49 : ?

(A) 142
(B) 152
(C) 147
(D) 144

Q.20

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. ABCD, YZEF, WXGH, UVIJ, ?

(A) STKL
(B) STLM
(C) TSKL
(D) TLSK

Q.21

Drake, Pawan, Gagan, Laxman are sitting around a circular table facing the centre(but not necessarily in the same order). Drake is to the immediate right of Gagan, and Laxman is exactly between Drake and Pawan. Which of the following is true about the arrangement?

(A) Pawan is to the immediate left of Laxman.
(B) Pawan is to the immediate left of Gagan.
(C) Drake is to the immediate neighbour of pawan and Gagan.
(D) Drake is to the immediate left of Pawan.

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. HP : DT :: RX : ?

(A) MB
(B) MC
(C) NC
(D) NB

Q.23

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? $5 - 4 \div 2 \times 10 + 7 = 7$

(A) 10 and 2
(B) 5 and 7
(C) 5 and 2
(D) 10 and 5

Q.25

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 48, 96, 288, 1152, ?, 34560

(A) 5980
(B) 5760
(C) 5850
(D) 5720

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Ustad Amjad Ali Khan Bangash is an Indian classical _____ player.

(A) violin
(B) sarod
(C) guitar
(D) sitar

Q.2

Which Article of the Constitution of India provides protection of life and personal liberty?

(A) Article 27
(B) Article 24
(C) Article 21
(D) Article 19

Q.3
Which of the following is a dark reddish coloured stone used as raw material in aluminium smelting?

(A) Mica
(B) Gypsum
(C) Bauxite
(D) Conglomerate

Q.4
Which of the following metals reacts violently with cold water?

(A) Magnesium
(B) Aluminium
(C) Zinc
(D) Potassium

Q.5
Which of the following is NOT a greenhouse gas?

(A) Nitrogen
(B) Methane
(C) Carbon dioxide
(D) Nitrous oxide

Q.6
Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of Kingdom Fungi?

(A) No mechanisms for locomotion
(B) Multicellular structure
(C) With a cell wall
(D) With chloroplasts

Q.7
Which of the following contains the largest amount of fresh water on earth?

(A) Ice caps
(B) Inland seas
(C) Atmosphere
(D) Groundwater

Q.8
Who led the Battle of Plassey on behalf of the British East India Company?

(A) Charles Stuart
(B) Warren Hastings
(C) Robert Clive
(D) James Lancaster

Q.9
Which of the following is a housing scheme for the rural poor?

(A) Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana
(B) Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana
(C) Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas Yojana
(D) Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana

Q.10
What is the name of the autobiography of famous Indian cricketer, Yuvraj Singh?

(A) Straight from the Heart
(B) Wings of Fire
(C) The Race of My Life
(D) The Test of My Life

Q.11
Census 2011 was the _____ National Census of India.

(A) 11th
(B) 20th
(C) 17th
(D) 15th

Q.12
Bihu is a folk dance of _____.

(A) Bihar
(B) Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Assam
(D) Karnataka

Q.13
As per the Rigvedic or Early Vedic Period (1500-1000 BC), who among the following was a River Goddess?

(A) Agni
(B) Sindhu
(C) Arika
(D) Usha

Q.14
Babur, the first Mughal emperor, succeeded to the throne of Ferghana in 1494 when he was only _____ years old.

(A) 18
(B) 12
(C) 15
(D) 10

Q.15
The northern plain in India is formed of which soil?

(A) Laterite soil
(B) Arid soil
(C) Alluvial soil
(D) Black soil

Q.16
Khel Nursery Scheme 2022-23 has been launched to promote sports in _____.

(A) Haryana
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Andhra Pradesh
(D) Maharashtra

Q.17
According to the Constitution of India, the executive power of the State shall be vested in the _____.

(A) President of India
(B) Governor of the state
(C) Chief Minister of the state
(D) Advocate-General of the state

Q.18
In which state of India is Khajuraho dance festival celebrated?

(A) Nagaland
(B) Kerala
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.19
The Mughal emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar died in _____.

(A) 1857
(B) 1858
(C) 1862
(D) 1859

Q.20
Which of the following persons took over as the Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) in September 2021?

(A) Arup Raha
(B) Manoj Mukund Naravane
(C) Rakesh Kumar Singh Bhadauria
(D) Vivek Ram Chaudhari

Q.21
Who among the following is the recipient of 2021 Abhinandan Saroja National Award by National Institute of Indian Classical Dance?

(A) Nalini Asthana
(B) Aparna Satheesan
(C) Rashid Khan
(D) S Ballesh Bhajantri

Q.22
Deepika Kumari is associated with which sport?

(A) Golf
(B) Chess
(C) Tennis
(D) Archery

Q.23

Who among the following Indian cricketers is also known as 'Master Blaster'?

(A) Sachin Tendulkar
(B) Rahul Dravid
(C) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(D) Kapil Dev

Q.24

What is the rate of income tax (new regime) payable for financial year 2021-2022, by an individual who is under 60 years of age, and has a net income of less than ₹5 lakhs but more than ₹2.5 lakhs?

(A) 10%
(B) 20%
(C) 2.5%
(D) 5%

Q.25

Dholavira, which was the ancient Harappan site was divided into _____ parts.

(A) three
(B) five
(C) four
(D) two

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) To achieve two things by doing a single action

To 'kill two birds with one stone' is to achieve two aims with a single action.

Q.2 · Answer (C) there she have

An action completed before another past action takes the past perfect, and 'she' never takes 'have': 'When I reached there, she had already started eating.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) that happens in nature

'Everything' is singular, so the verb is 'happens', and 'nature' in this sense has no plural: 'Not everything that happens in nature is due to global warming alone.'

Q.4 · Answer (A) Respond to someone with anger that is often sudden or unprovoked

To 'bite someone's head off' is to speak to them angrily and sharply, often for no good reason.

Q.5 · Answer (C) ideal

'Ideal' means perfectly suitable: the park suits strolling and exercise well. 'Doubtful', 'fussy' and 'unopen' do not fit the sense.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Complex

The opposite of 'simple' is 'complex'. 'Clear' is close to 'simple' in sense, and 'auspicious' (favourable) and 'antiquated' (out of date) are unrelated.

Q.7 · Answer (B) bore

To 'bear away' a prize is to win it, and the past tense of 'bear' is 'bore': the students 'bore away all the prizes'. 'Borne' and 'bearing' need a helping verb, and 'bears' does not agree with the plural 'students'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) more than

Comparisons take 'than'; 'then' refers to time: 'more than the usual amount of garbage'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Acronym

An acronym, such as NATO, is formed from initial letters and said as a word. A caption is the text under a picture, a slogan a catchy motto, and a flotilla a small fleet of ships.

Q.10 · Answer (C) praised

One 'praises' someone for something, that is speaks approvingly of them: 'praised the maid for her hard work'. 'Priced', 'prized' and 'prayed' are look-alike words that do not fit.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Rush

'Bustle' is busy, hurried activity: 'rush'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Contencious

The correct spelling is 'contentious', ending in '-tious', not '-cious'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) standing at front of us

The phrase is 'in front of': 'this problem standing in front of us'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Dependable

'Reliable' means able to be trusted: 'dependable'. 'Doubtful', 'dubious' and 'dodgy' mean nearly the opposite.

Q.15 · Answer (D) emerged

'Emerge' takes no object, so it has no passive ('were being emerged'); the simple past fits: 'many new ideas about education and learning emerged'. 'Was emerging' does not agree with the plural 'ideas'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) had taking her car keys

The past perfect is 'had' with the past participle: 'had taken her car keys'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) gave him some
'I' does not take 'gives'; of the options only the past tense fits: 'I gave him some orange juice from the refrigerator.' 'Given' needs a helping verb, and 'any' is used mainly in questions and negatives.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Impractical
'Pragmatic' means practical and realistic, so its opposite is 'impractical'. 'Prudent' (careful) is close to it in sense.

Q.19 · Answer (D) narrow
'Neither ... nor' here pairs opposites to describe a street of middling width: neither broad nor 'narrow'. 'Wide' would only repeat 'broad'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) I should secure some company for my lonely hours.
The correct spellings are 'secure' and 'lonely' (lone + -ly).

Q.21 · Answer (B) succumbed
To 'succumb to' an illness is to die of it, and the verb takes 'to': 'succumbed to the Nipah virus infection'. 'Died' would need 'of'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) undergoing
One 'undergoes' treatment, that is receives it: 'who had been undergoing treatment'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) in
Months take 'in': 'had died of the infection in May'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) toll
The 'death toll' is the number of people killed: it has 'gone up to 12'. 'Tole', 'scroll' and 'roll' only rhyme with it.

Q.25 · Answer (C) tested
Samples examined and found to carry the infection have 'tested positive'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) gi
'Life' is in the first two sentences and 'ri' in both their codes, so 'life' = 'ri'; likewise 'is' = 'mi' (second and third). 'Love', in the first and third, is the code those two share: 'gi'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) IKJ18
Each letter moves 3 back and the number rises by 6: SUT5 → PRQ11 and DFE8 → ACB14. So LNM12 → IKJ18.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Three
C, with just two below it, is at level 5, and M, with more than four above it, at level 6, as L is at 7. K, B and A are on consecutive levels with O above K, which fills levels 1 to 4 as O, K, B, A. So three employees (O, K and B) are above A.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 50
25 − 35 + 12 × 25 ÷ 5 = 25 − 35 + 12 × 5 = 25 − 35 + 60 = 50.

Q.7 · Answer (D) XTH
The letters move +6, −8 and +10: P → V, I → A and N → X. So R → X, B → T (counting back past A) and X → H (counting on past Z): XTH.

Q.8 · Answer (C) fg @
'Black' is in the first two sentences, so it is 'rm'; 'are', in the first and third, is '@'; and 'creatures', in the second and third, is 'fg'. So 'creatures are' is 'fg @'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 8
'Burning' is in both sentences and 3 in both codes, so 'burning' = 3. 'Are' is then 7 or 8, and of the options only 8 is possible.

Q.10 · Answer (D) None of the conclusions follow
The statements meet only in M, so nothing is known about X and D: neither I ('All X are D') nor III ('Some X are not D') can be concluded, though one of the two must be true. II contradicts 'Some D are M'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 29 : 87
57 = 19 × 3, and likewise 87 = 29 × 3. The other pairs fail: 23 × 3 = 69, 31 × 3 = 93 and 17 × 3 = 51.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 5
The second number is half the first plus 2: 12 ÷ 2 + 2 = 8 and 28 ÷ 2 + 2 = 16. So 6 ÷ 2 + 2 = 5.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
The tyres that are bats are also laws, so only some laws need be bats, and nothing says every bat is a tyre: neither conclusion follows.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 45
Each word's code is the sum of its letters' places in the alphabet: WORK = 23 + 15 + 18 + 11 = 67 and CUP = 3 + 21 + 16 = 40. So KITE = 11 + 9 + 20 + 5 = 45.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 144
The second number is 3 times one less than the first: 3 × (16 − 1) = 45 and 3 × (36 − 1) = 105. So 3 × (49 − 1) = 144.

Q.20 · Answer (A) STKL
The first two letters move 2 back each time (AB, YZ, WX, UV, ST) and the last two 2 forward (CD, EF, GH, IJ, KL): STKL.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Pawan is to the immediate left of Gagan.
Facing the centre, a person's left neighbour is the next seat clockwise. Drake sits to Gagan's right, and Laxman, between Drake and Pawan, takes the seat beside Drake, so clockwise the order is Gagan, Pawan, Laxman, Drake: Pawan is to Gagan's immediate left.

Q.22 · Answer (D) NB
The first letter moves 4 back and the second 4 forward: H → D and P → T. So R → N and X → B (counting on past Z): NB.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 10 and 5
After interchanging 10 and 5: 10 − 4 ÷ 2 × 5 + 7 = 10 − 10 + 7 = 7.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 5760
The terms are multiplied by 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6 in turn: 1152 × 5 = 5760 and 5760 × 6 = 34560.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) sarod
Ustad Amjad Ali Khan of the Bangash gharana is a sarod player, as was his father, Ustad Hafiz Ali Khan.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Article 21
Article 21 protects life and personal liberty, of which no person may be deprived except by procedure established by law. Article 19 guarantees six freedoms, Article 24 prohibits child labour in factories, mines and hazardous work, and Article 27 bars taxes for promoting a religion.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Bauxite
Bauxite, the ore of aluminium, is a bulky, dark reddish rock; it is refined into alumina, which the smelters reduce to the metal. Mica and gypsum are other minerals, and a conglomerate is a sedimentary rock of rounded pebbles.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Potassium
Potassium and sodium react so violently with cold water that the hydrogen given off catches fire. Magnesium reacts only with hot water, and aluminium and zinc with steam.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Nitrogen
Nitrogen, about 78% of the air, does not absorb the heat the Earth radiates, so it is not a greenhouse gas; methane, carbon dioxide and nitrous oxide are.

Q.6 · Answer (D) With chloroplasts
Fungi have no chlorophyll or chloroplasts: they are heterotrophs that absorb their food from dead or living matter. Most are multicellular (yeast is an exception), they have cell walls of chitin, and they do not move about.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Ice caps
Ice caps, glaciers and permanent snow hold about two-thirds of the Earth's fresh water; groundwater holds most of the rest, about 30%.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Robert Clive
Robert Clive led the Company's forces to victory over Siraj-ud-Daulah, the Nawab of Bengal, at Plassey in June 1757. Warren Hastings was named the first Governor-General of Bengal by the Regulating Act of 1773.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas Yojana
The Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana - Gramin, restructured from the Indira Awaas Yojana in 2016, helps rural households without a pucca house to build one. Jan Dhan is about bank accounts, Jeevan Jyoti Bima about life insurance and Kaushal Vikas about skill training.

Q.10 · Answer (D) The Test of My Life
Yuvraj Singh's autobiography, 'The Test of My Life' (2013), tells of his fight against cancer. 'Straight from the Heart' is Kapil Dev's, 'Wings of Fire' A P J Abdul Kalam's and 'The Race of My Life' Milkha Singh's.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 15th
Census 2011 was the 15th national census since the first, in 1872, and the 7th since independence.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Assam
Bihu, danced at the Bihu festivals, is the best-known folk dance of Assam.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Sindhu
Sindhu, the Indus, is among the rivers the Rigveda praises as goddesses, the Sarasvati being another. Usha is the goddess of the dawn and Agni the god of fire.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 12
SSC's key gives 12, the age usually given: Babur became ruler of Ferghana on his father's death in June 1494, in what his memoir, the Baburnama, calls the twelfth year of his age. Born in February 1483, he was strictly 11, which is not an option.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Alluvial soil
The northern plains are built of alluvium laid down by the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra and their tributaries.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Haryana
Haryana announced its Khel Nursery Scheme 2022-23 in December 2021: sports nurseries in government institutions and private educational and sports institutions, for sports played at the Olympic, Asian and Commonwealth Games.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Governor of the state
Article 154(1) vests the executive power of a State in its Governor, who exercises it directly or through officers subordinate to him.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Madhya Pradesh
The Khajuraho Dance Festival, a week of classical dance, is held each year against the backdrop of the Khajuraho temples in Chhatarpur district, Madhya Pradesh.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 1862
Bahadur Shah Zafar, the last Mughal emperor, was exiled to Rangoon after the revolt of 1857 and died there in November 1862.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Vivek Ram Chaudhari
Air Chief Marshal Vivek Ram Chaudhari took over as Chief of the Air Staff on 30 September 2021, succeeding R K S Bhadauria. M M Naravane was then the Army chief, and Arup Raha headed the Air Force from 2013 to 2016.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Aparna Satheesan
SSC's key gives Aparna Satheesan, a US-based Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer; a press release of November 2021 reported that she had received the institute's 2021 award.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Archery
Deepika Kumari is an Indian recurve archer who has been ranked world number one.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Sachin Tendulkar
Sachin Tendulkar is known as the 'Master Blaster'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 5%
Under the new regime for 2021-22 (section 115BAC), income up to ₹2.5 lakh was exempt and income from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹5 lakh was taxed at 5%. A rebate under section 87A cancelled this tax when the total income did not exceed ₹5 lakh.

Q.25 · Answer (A) three
Dholavira, a Harappan city in the Rann of Kutch, Gujarat, was divided into three parts (the citadel, the middle town and the lower town), each walled with stone.

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